Homemade Hummus, My Way

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

I like my hummus very smooth, creamy and generous on the lemon.

Serves 6–8 · Prep 15 min

INGREDIENTS

- 480 g cooked chickpeas, weighed after draining
- ½ cup tahini
- Juice of up to 2 lemons, to taste
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 2 ice cubes
- 3 tbsp ice-cold water, plus a little extra if needed
- A pinch of salt, adjusted to taste

METHOD

1. Prepare the chickpeas. If using canned chickpeas, drain and rinse them, then place in a saucepan with fresh water. Bring to a boil and simmer until very soft. If cooking dried chickpeas from scratch, soak them overnight in plenty of water, then drain, rinse and cook in fresh water until very tender. In either case, they should mash easily under gentle pressure from a fork. Drain, allow to cool and weigh out 480 g.
2. Place the chickpeas and ice cubes in a food processor suitable for crushing ice. Blend thoroughly until they form a thick paste, stopping to scrape down the sides as needed.
3. Add the tahini gradually, blending between additions until fully incorporated.
4. Add a pinch of salt and some of the lemon juice. Blend, taste and gradually add more juice until the hummus has the bright, citrusy flavour you like. You may need less than two lemons, depending on their size, juiciness and acidity.
5. Add the olive oil and blend until incorporated.
6. Gradually add the ice-cold water, one tablespoon at a time, blending between additions. Use the three tablespoons as a guide, adding a little more only if needed to reach a soft, creamy consistency.
7. Continue blending until the hummus is very smooth, pausing to scrape down the sides and allowing the machine to rest if necessary. Taste once more and adjust the salt and lemon.
8. Spoon onto a serving plate, cover and refrigerate for at least one hour before serving.

Tip

Soft chickpeas are essential. Even canned chickpeas benefit from further cooking. They should yield easily to a fork, with no firm centre.